

Hypertension – Medical Summary

Overview

Hypertension, commonly called high blood pressure, is a condition in which blood pressure remains consistently elevated. Persistent hypertension can place additional stress on the heart and blood vessels.

Risk Factors

Risk factors can include family history, increasing age, excess body weight, high sodium intake, physical inactivity, smoking, excessive alcohol consumption, and certain medical conditions.

Symptoms

Hypertension often does not cause noticeable symptoms. Regular blood pressure measurement is therefore important.

Diagnosis

Blood pressure is measured using a blood pressure monitor. Multiple measurements taken on different occasions may be used to confirm persistent hypertension.

Management

Treatment may include reducing sodium intake, maintaining a healthy weight, exercising regularly, avoiding tobacco, limiting alcohol, and taking prescription medicines when required.

Possible Complications

Long-term uncontrolled hypertension can increase the risk of stroke, heart disease, kidney disease, and other cardiovascular complications.

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